

The Ritual Called the Chuchunḍhara (Ritual of Teu-lopa)

Chuchunḍharakalpa-nāmas · Toh 472 · Derge Kangyur

ཏཱེ་ལཱ་པའི་ཆོ་ག་ཞེས་བ་བྱ

Toh 472 in the Kangyur is a tantric ritual text known in Sanskrit as the Chuchundharakalpa and in Tibetan as Teulo pa'i cho ga, meaning roughly the Ritual of Teu-lopa or the Chuchunḍhara Ritual. The text belongs to the class of tantric manuals concerned with the practical application of a specific vidyā-mantra associated with Chuchunḍhara, a figure invoked alongside Yamāntaka, the wrathful slayer-deity. It prescribes a sequence of ritual activities including offerings of fragrance, flowers, and incense, prolonged mantra recitation, and the use of powdered remains of the chuchunḍhara creature to achieve various forms of tantric accomplishment. As a sādhana-style compendium of ritual procedures oriented toward worldly and supramundane goals, it sits within the broader category of Tantric texts in the Kangyur.

— while suppressing, one takes the oath. The tale-cycle of reflections is complete.

In the language of India: Chuchundharakalpa-namas. In the Tibetan language: the text called the Ritual of Teu-lopa — homage to the slayer Yamāntaka. Now the detailed exposition of the ritual of Chuchunḍhara:

Oṃ tutrayā Maheśvara-yoga-prattamaya, yoga-siddhi, dāhāni me svāhā, hū ha, daha daha, paca paca, urdhiya hūṃ phaṭ.

The ritual activity of this vidyā-mantra is as follows. Without sleeping by day or night, after offering fragrances, flowers, and incense, one sends off the ritual cake and recites eight thousand times; by this, accomplishment is obtained.

Now, the various activities that arise from it. Take a dead chuchunḍhara, reduce its skin, bones, flesh, and hair to powder, recite two thousand times, and apply that powder to one's own forehead — one becomes invisible to enemies. Oṃ mama hū pati. Rub that powder on the hand, and whoever is touched comes under one's power. Rub that powder on the feet and, even if one has gone a hundred leagues, one returns. Rub that same powder on the wall of the enemy's door and recite one hundred thousand times at one's own house-door — the enemy is driven away. Cut a piece of charnel-ground cloth and conceal it at the enemy's doorstep along with that powder — the enemy's

kindred are destroyed. If one wishes to drive away the enemy's kindred, reduce the skin of the chuchunḍhara to powder, recite eight thousand times completely, fill it with earth from a spot where urine has collected, bind it with blue thread, and raise it into the sky — the urine will be blocked. If it is released, one is freed. Reduce the skin of the chuchunḍhara to powder, recite eight thousand times before the great god (Śiva), then again offer fragrances, flowers, incense, and the ritual cake, and again recite eight thousand times — by this, accomplishment is obtained. If that powder is rubbed on the tip of one's nose, one becomes beloved by all living beings. If it is placed on one's head, one gains the upper hand over all enemies in dispute. If that same powder is rubbed on one's own chest and shown to an enemy, the enemy will suffer heart pain. If a figure is made from rice flour and that powder is rubbed on it, beauty is attained. If powder mixed with charnel-ground ash is thrown into a crowd of enemies, all those pressed down by it or who see it will be struck by illness. Recite that powder one thousand times and pour it over whoever's head — that person comes under one's power. If that powder together with a skull is placed against a wall, the enemy will be separated and driven off. If that powder is rubbed on a woman's hand, that woman will die. If that powder is concealed at someone's door, that person is driven away. If that powder is mixed with great flesh and given to someone to drink, in seven days they will die. Give that powder to the enemy, and the enemy will be afflicted by hunger, dysentery, and fever, while oneself rejoices from afar. Take the bones of the chuchunḍhara and conceal them in someone's house — they will die. Take the flesh of the chuchunḍhara together with fish fat, perform an offering to the deity, then sit in the charnel ground upon a skull, hold the skull and recite; pour one thousand times into the charnel-ground's burning coals and perform a fire offering — accomplishment is obtained. Mix that same powder with the three hot spices — the activity is this: if it is placed in someone's house, the three fires of heat will arise for that person. Mix that powder with poison likewise and the very same activity results. Make an effigy from that powder together with charnel-ground earth and conceal it at a doorstep — it will kill quickly by illness. Mix that powder with salt and strike whoever with it — that person comes under one's power. Mix that powder with white mustard and throw it at the king's door —

the king comes under one's power.

The detailed analysis of the Tsutsudhara is complete.

Translated by the Indian master Dīpaṃkara and the Tibetan translator Ra Dorje Drak.

Translator's Notes

- The term "chuchunḍhara" (Tib. transliteration of Skt. chuchunḍhara) refers to the common musk shrew, a small insectivore. The ritual text presents it under the Sanskrit title "Chuchundhara-kalpa" and attributes it to "Teu-lopa" (likely a corruption of Tilopa or a related siddha name). The passage is a ritual manual (kalpa) of a distinctly tantric-magical character, describing wrathful rites involving Yamāntaka; it is not a canonical Dharma text in the ordinary sense but belongs to the genre of practical siddha manuals preserved in the Tibetan canon. The Sanskrit mantra string has been transliterated as found, since it is a phonetic mantra not amenable to grammatical translation. The phrase "three fires of heat" likely refers to the three fires (hunger, thirst, and burning) as a formulaic curse expression. "Great flesh" is likely a euphemism for a ritually impure or forbidden meat, consistent with charnel-ground practice contexts.

- Tsutsudhara renders the Sanskrit title Cchucchundharā, a dhāraṇī text. The colophon names Dīpaṃkara Śrījñāna (Atiśa) as the Indian paṇḍita and Ra Dorje Drak as the Tibetan lotsāwa.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.